Part 2. Audience

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Who the audience is

We first defined who will read the dashboard. The audience is a small group of analysts at a regional tourism observatory for Lisbon. They read charts every week at work, so their expertise is medium: they know bar and line charts and percentages, but they are not statisticians. They will open the dashboard on a desktop computer at their office, once a month, when they prepare the monthly tourism report. Because the data covers only two hotels, a city hotel and a resort, the analysts use it as a case study of the two destination types, not as a picture of the whole region.

Persona and scenario

Marta, 38, is a tourism analyst with a degree in economics. Her job is to advise the regional board on when and where to promote each destination. She has deuteranopia, a form of red-green colour vision deficiency, so colour alone cannot carry information for her. Her goal is to understand when the city and the resort are busy and which countries their guests come from, so that campaigns are launched at the right time in the right markets. In the first days of each month she sits at her desk, opens the dashboard, reads the key figures, compares the seasons of both destinations on the main screen and then studies the source markets on the detail screen before writing her report.

Goals and questions

The dashboard must show Marta, at a glance, when each destination is busy, where its guests come from and how much demand is lost to cancellations. Seven questions, written from her point of view, follow from this goal: three guide the main screen and four the detail screen on source markets.

#	Question	Screen
Q1	In which months do the city and the resort receive most guests?	Main
Q2	Which countries do the guests come from, and is the mix different in each destination?	Detail
Q3	Does each source market travel at a different time of the year?	Detail
Q4	How long do guests from each market stay?	Detail
Q5	How much demand is lost through cancellations, and in which months and markets?	Main
Q6	How far in advance do guests from each market book?	Detail
Q7	How does the price per night change through the year in each destination?	Main